

The Home Cook's Guide to Healthy Eating

Balanced Plate Basics

A balanced plate is roughly half vegetables and fruit, one quarter lean protein, and one quarter whole grains. Adding a small portion of healthy fats, such as olive oil, nuts, or avocado, improves nutrient absorption.

Adults should aim for at least five servings of fruits and vegetables per day and drink around 2 liters of water. Limiting added sugar to less than 25 grams daily is recommended for most adults.

Meal Prep Tips

Cook grains and proteins in bulk on Sunday. Cooked quinoa and brown rice keep well in the fridge for up to five days. Store chopped vegetables in airtight containers lined with paper towels to absorb moisture.

Grilled chicken breast should reach an internal temperature of 74 degrees Celsius. Fish such as salmon is done at 63 degrees Celsius.

Food	Calories (per 100 g)	Protein (g)
Chicken breast	165	31
Quinoa (cooked)	120	4.4
Salmon	208	20
Lentils (cooked)	116	9

Sample Recipe: Lemon Herb Quinoa Bowl

Ingredients: 1 cup quinoa, 2 cups vegetable broth, 1 cucumber, 200 g cherry tomatoes, 1 lemon, fresh parsley, 2 tablespoons olive oil, and 100 g feta cheese.

Method: Rinse the quinoa and simmer in broth for 15 minutes. Let cool, then toss with diced cucumber, halved tomatoes, lemon juice, olive oil, and parsley. Top with crumbled feta. Serves 2 and takes about 25 minutes.